Morley Talent Solutions

FOR RECRUITERS AND HIRING MANAGERS

Recruitment Kickoff Kit

A ready-to-use guide for your intake meeting. Save it as a template and make a copy for each kickoff.

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How to use this guide

One structured meeting before the search starts, so you and the hiring manager are looking for the same person.

Before, during and after

Before	If you can, share the Hiring Manager Prep Sheet ahead of time. A quick look at the job description, the team and any past postings helps you arrive with context.
During	Allow enough time for a real conversation. Use the five parts as a guide, not a script, and note answers in the space under each question.
After	Share a short summary of what you heard and confirm it with the hiring manager. Early sample profiles are a quick way to check you're aligned.

Tips

- Save this PDF as a template and make a fresh copy for each kickoff.
- Follow the conversation. You can come back to anything you skip.
- Listen more than you talk, and note answers in the hiring manager's own words. They often make the best pitch.
- Use the "Go deeper" prompts when you want more detail.
- Keep every requirement tied to the job itself.

The five parts

1. **Role** Who the person reports to, who they work with, and what they're responsible for.
2. **Context** Why the role is open now, its history, and how the search will run.
3. **Success profile** What success looks like, the skills it takes, and where to find it.
4. **Compensation and logistics** The package, and where and how the person will work.
5. **Process** How candidates will be interviewed and chosen, and how you'll work together.

Part 1: Role

Who the person reports to, who they work with, and what they're responsible for.

1. **Who will this person report to?**

2. **Describe the team this person will be joining.**

3. **Who are the main stakeholders this person will work with?**

4. **What problem does this role solve for the business?**

   Go deeper: *What will this person own that no one owns today?*

5. **How would you describe the role if you were pitching it to a top candidate?**

   Go deeper: *What would make a top candidate say yes?*

6. **What is the official title and level?**

7. **Is the role permanent or contract, and is there a probation period?**

8. **Is the role approved and budgeted, and how many people are you hiring?**

Part 2: Context

Why the role is open now, its history, and how the search will run.

1. **Why do we want to hire this role now?**

   Go deeper: *What changed recently that made this a priority?*

2. **Has the role existed before? If so, how long was the previous person in the seat and what happened?**

   Go deeper: *What worked well in the role, and what would you like done differently?*

3. **What does the career path look like for someone doing this job at the company or in general?**

4. **What would make someone want to join? (mission, growth, funding, team)**

5. **Are there internal candidates or referrals already in process?**

6. **Is the search confidential?**

7. **Is the role posted, and are other recruiters working on it?**

Posting the role? Ontario introduced new rules for public job postings on January 1, 2026. They cover pay ranges, the use of AI and how employers follow up with interviewed applicants. Other provinces and US states have their own rules, so check with your HR or legal team before you post.

Part 3: Success profile

What success looks like, the skills it takes, and where to find it.

1. **What do we expect from them in the first 90 days?**

   Go deeper: *How will you measure success at 90 days?*

2. **What are the main 3–5 categories of responsibilities they will have?**

3. **What hard skills do they need to do the work?**

   Go deeper: *Which two or three matter most on day one?*

4. **What can they learn on the job?**

5. **How important is industry knowledge?**

6. **Are there profiles you can share of people who were successful in this job in the past?**

7. **Which companies or backgrounds should we target?**

8. **Are there companies you've decided not to recruit from, such as your own clients?**

9. **Are there any deal-breakers? (Keep them job-related.)**

Part 4: Compensation and logistics

The package, and where and how the person will work.

1. **What is the realistic total compensation we are targeting?**

   Go deeper: *How firm is the base salary range, and who approves going above it?*

2. **Is there a bonus or commission? For sales roles: the base and commission split, the quota, and how long until full quota.**

3. **Is there equity? How much, and when is it earned (vesting)?**

4. **Is there a signing bonus or relocation support?**

5. **Will this role be eligible for company benefits?**

   Go deeper: *When do benefits start, and what's included?*

6. **What is the work arrangement: hybrid (how many days), remote or onsite?**

   Go deeper: *Where is the office, and is travel required?*

7. **Where can the hire live and work? Is work permit or visa sponsorship possible?**

8. **What are the working hours and time zone?**

Part 5: Process

How candidates will be interviewed and chosen, and how you'll work together.

1. **What are the interview steps, and who is involved in each one?**

   Go deeper: *What will each step assess, and how many interview slots can the team hold each week?*

2. **Who makes the final decision?**

3. **What is your target start date for the new hire, and how flexible is it?**

4. **How often would you like updates, and where (email, Slack, a weekly call)?**